1908 Hermann Minkowski unifies space and time into an absolute four-dimensional spacetime. [Ch. 2]

1912 Einstein realizes that spacetime is curved, and that tidal gravity is a manifestation of that curvature. [Ch. 2]

1915 Einstein and Hilbert independently formulate the Einstein field equation (which describes how mass curves spacetime), thereby completing the laws of general relativity. [Ch. 2]

1916 Karl Schwarzschild discovers the Schwarzschild solution of the Einstein field equation, which later will turn out to describe nonspinning, uncharged black holes. [Ch. 3]

Flamm discovers that, with an appropriate choice of topology, the Schwarzschild solution of the Einstein equation can describe a wormhole. [Ch. 14]

1916&1918 Reissner and Nordstrom discover their solution of the Einstein field equation, which later will describe nonspinning, charged black holes. [Ch. 7]

1926 Eddington poses the mystery of the white dwarfs and attacks the reality of black holes. [Ch. 4]

Schrödinger and Heisenberg, building on others' work, complete the formulation of the quantum mechanical laws of physics. [Ch. 4]

Fowler uses the quantum mechanical laws to show how electron degeneracy resolves the mystery of the white dwarfs. [Ch. 4]

1930 Chandrasekhar discovers that there is a maximum mass for white dwarfs. [Ch. 4]

1932 Chadwick discovers the neutron. [Ch. 5]

1933 Jansky discovers cosmic radio waves. [Ch. 9]

1934 Landau creates his research group in the V.S.S.R. and begins to transfuse theoretical physics there from Western Europe. [Ch. 5, 13]